

ECON 3HH3: International Trade

Spring 2026

Instructor Information

Instructor Name: Pau S. Pujolas

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Office hours: Posted on Avenue to Learn (A2L)

Course Information

Lectures: all materials are online in A2L

Labs: No

Tutorials: No

Course Dates: 2026/05/04- 2026/06/19

Units: 3.0

Course Delivery Mode: On line

Course Description: Real theory of international trade; interregional and international specialization; effect of commercial and industrial policies.

Hours of Study: 6 hours week + 2 sessions of video

Instructor-Specific Course Information

This course provides an introduction to the basis, consequences and policies of international trade and to the multilateral trading system and institutions such as the World Trade Organization. This course develops basic theories of international trade. These theories will help understand the reasons why countries trade goods and services and firms invest abroad; the determinants of trade patterns; and the impact of (gains and losses from) trade on welfare and economic development. The insights of these theories will help as well to address policy issues, such as trade and investment policies. We are interested to answer questions such as: Do countries gain from trade? How much? Are there losers from trade? Why do countries

implement protectionist trade policies? What is the role of the WTO? Why do countries sign preferential trade agreements? What are the political forces that shape trade policies?

Meeting Details

No sessions. We will post all the material online.

Important Links

- [Mosaic](#)
- [Avenue to Learn](#)
- [Student Accessibility Services - Accommodations](#)
- [McMaster University Library](#)
- [eReserves](#)

Course Learning Outcomes

The student will know all the necessary aspects of modern trade theory, all the relevant facts of international trade, as well as how to think about trade policy in this day and age.

Course Learning Goals

Familiarize with the theory of Ricardo, Heckscher-Ohlin, Krugman, etc. Learn about the empirical support for those theories. Use those theories to understand trade policy.

Materials and Fees

Title: International Trade

ISBN: 9 781 319 218 454

Authors: Robert Feenstra and Alan Taylor

Publisher: McMillan

Publication Date: 2021

Edition: Any edition works; preferable to use Edition 4.

Textbook Listing: <https://store.macmillanlearning.com/ca/product/International-Trade/p/1319218458>

Course Evaluation

The exams are NOT cumulative. The best midterm grade will be worth 45%, the second best will be worth 30%, the least good midterm will be worth 25%.

All the exams will take place online. They will be Quizzes on A2L.

The exams will take place on May 22nd, June 5th, and June 19th.

Grading Scale

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Grade	Equivalent Grade Point	Equivalent Percentages
A+	12	90-100
A	11	85-89
A-	10	80-84
B+	9	77-79
B	8	73-76
B-	7	70-72
C+	6	67-69
C	5	63-66
C-	4	60-62
D+	3	57-59
D	2	53-56
D-	1	50-52
F	0	0-49

Course Schedule

Each week we cover 2 different chapters of the book.

Late Assignments

There are no assignments in this course.

Absences, Missed Work or Illness

No MSAF through self-report, as the weight is 25% or more for each exam.

If an MSAF through Administrative report is used, a make-up exam will be scheduled in lieu.

Course Modification

The instructor and university reserve the right to modify elements of the course during the term. The university may change the dates and deadlines for any or all courses in extreme circumstances. If either type of modification becomes necessary, reasonable notice and communication with the students will be given with an explanation and the opportunity to comment on changes. It is the responsibility of the student to check their McMaster email and course websites weekly during the term and to note any changes.

Generative AI

Generative AI cannot be used during exams/tests.

APPROVED ADVISORY STATEMENTS

Academic Integrity

You are expected to exhibit honesty and use ethical behaviour in all aspects of the learning process. Academic credentials you earn are rooted in principles of honesty and academic integrity. **It is your responsibility to understand what constitutes academic dishonesty.**

Academic dishonesty is to knowingly act or fail to act in a way that results or could result in unearned academic credit or advantage. This behaviour can result in serious consequences, e.g. the grade of zero on an assignment, loss of credit with a notation on the transcript (notation reads: "Grade of F assigned for academic dishonesty"), and/or suspension or expulsion from the university. For information on the various types of academic dishonesty please refer to the [Academic Integrity Policy](https://secretariat.mcmaster.ca/university-policies-proceduresguidelines/), located at <https://secretariat.mcmaster.ca/university-policies-proceduresguidelines/>

The following illustrates only three forms of academic dishonesty:

- plagiarism, e.g. the submission of work that is not one's own or for which other credit has been obtained.

- improper collaboration in group work.
- copying or using unauthorized aids in tests and examinations.

Email Communication

Effective September 1, 2010, it is the policy of the Faculty of Social Sciences that all e-mail communication sent from students to instructors (including Tasks), and from students to staff, must originate from the student's own McMaster University e-mail account. This policy protects confidentiality and confirms the identity of the student. It is the student's responsibility to ensure that communication is sent to the university from a McMaster account. If an instructor becomes aware that a communication has come from an alternate address, the instructor may not reply at his/her/their discretion.

Courses with an On-line Element

Some courses may use on-line elements (e.g. e-mail, Avenue to Learn, LearnLink, web pages, capa, Moodle, ThinkingCap, etc.). Students should be aware that, when they access the electronic components of a course using these elements, private information such as first and last names, usernames for the McMaster e-mail accounts, and program affiliation may become apparent to all other students in the same course. The available information is dependent on the technology used. Continuation in a course that uses on-line elements will be deemed consent to this disclosure. If you have any questions or concerns about such disclosure, please discuss this with the course instructor.

Online Proctoring

Some courses may use online proctoring software for tests and exams. This software may require students to turn on their video camera, present identification, monitor and record their computer activities, and/or lock/restrict their browser or other applications/software during tests or exams. This software may be required to be installed before the test/exam begins.

Conduct Expectations

As a McMaster student, you have the right to experience, and the responsibility to demonstrate, respectful and dignified interactions within all of our living, learning and working communities. These expectations are described in the [Code of Student Rights & Responsibilities](#) (the "Code"). All students share the responsibility of maintaining a positive environment for the academic and personal growth of all McMaster community members, **whether in person or online.**

It is essential that students be mindful of their interactions online, as the Code remains in effect in virtual learning environments. The Code applies to any interactions that adversely affect, disrupt, or interfere with reasonable participation in University activities. Student disruptions or behaviours that interfere with university functions on online platforms (e.g. use of Avenue 2 Learn, WebEx or Zoom for delivery), will be taken very seriously and will be investigated.

Outcomes may include restriction or removal of the involved students' access to these platforms.

Academic Accommodation of Students with Disabilities

Students with disabilities who require academic accommodation must contact [Student Accessibility Services](#) (SAS) at 905-525-9140 ext. 28 652 or sas@mcmaster.ca to make arrangements with a Program Coordinator. For further information, consult McMaster University's [Academic Accommodation of Students with Disabilities](#) policy.

Requests for Relief for Missed Academic Term Work

In the event of an absence for medical or other reasons, students should review and follow the [Policy on Requests for Relief for Missed Academic Term Work](#).

Academic Accommodation for Religious, Indigenous, or Spiritual Observances (RISO)

Students requiring academic accommodation based on religious, indigenous or spiritual observances should follow the procedures set out in the [RISO](#) policy. Students should submit their request to their Faculty Office ***normally within 10 working days*** of the beginning of term in which they anticipate a need for accommodation or to the Registrar's Office prior to their examinations. Students should also contact their instructors as soon as possible to make alternative arrangements for classes, assignments, and tests.

Copyright and Recording

Students are advised that lectures, demonstrations, performances, and any other course material provided by an instructor include copyright protected works. The Copyright Act and copyright law protect every original literary, dramatic, musical and artistic work, **including lectures** by University instructors.

The recording of lectures, tutorials, or other methods of instruction may occur during a course. Recording may be done by either the instructor for the purpose of authorized distribution, or by a student for the purpose of personal study. Students should be aware that their voice and/or image may be recorded by others during the class. Please speak with the instructor if this is a concern for you.

Extreme Circumstances

The University reserves the right to change the dates and deadlines for any or all courses in extreme circumstances (e.g., severe weather, labour disruptions, etc.). Changes will be communicated through regular McMaster communication channels, such as McMaster Daily News, Avenue to Learn and/or McMaster email.